

The Network Platform

Working title: Andaman Aerodrome Network Platform (**AANP**). The name designates the core, operator-neutral layer of the system; it is a working title and can be re-branded without any technical change.

§ What the platform fundamentally is

AANP is the **digital operating system for a network of helipads, heliports and aircraft**. It is not a booking website with a flight database attached — it is the inverse: a complete aviation network management core, on top of which commercial products (tours, charters, transfers) are merely one category of consumer.

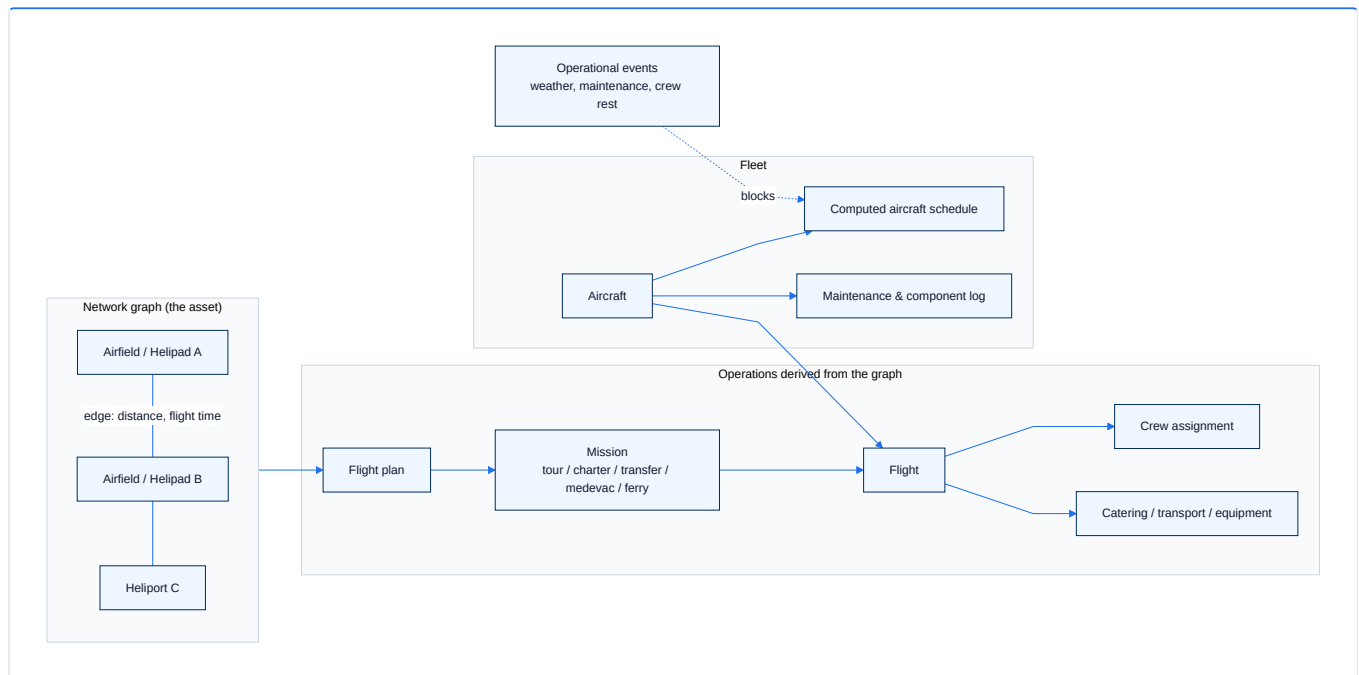
Everything an organization needs to **own, operate and expand a vertical-flight network** is a first-class citizen of the data model:

NETWORK CAPABILITY	PLATFORM IMPLEMENTATION
Helipads / heliports / airfields	<code>airfields</code> — location, timezone, contact, metadata
Route network between sites	<code>airfield_network_edges</code> — distance, flight time per leg
Aircraft fleet	<code>aircraft</code> — registration, model, capacity, default crew/components
Fleet maintenance & service log	<code>aircraft_events</code> , <code>aircraft_components</code>
Route planning	<code>flight_plans</code> — departure/arrival airfield, waypoints, duration
Work orders for any aviation activity	<code>missions</code> — typed: tour, charter, transfer, medevac, ferry
Scheduled operations	<code>flights</code> — aircraft, status lifecycle, departure time
Crew management	<code>flight_crew</code> — pilots, co-pilots, engineers, medics per flight
Flight logistics	<code>flight_components</code> — catering, ground transport, equipment
Network-wide disruptions	<code>operational_events</code> — maintenance, weather, crew rest, inspections

All of these live in the production database of `silkskyair-api` today (migrations `20251230300*` onward), protected by dedicated access privileges (`module:network:*` , `module:scheduling:*`) that separate network operations from every commercial concern.

§ The network is the graph; everything else follows

The model is deliberately graph-shaped: **airfields are nodes**, **network edges are routes**, and every flight the platform ever schedules is derived from that graph.



The consequence for expansion is structural: **adding a heliport to the network is a data operation, not a software project**. A new node plus its edges immediately participates in route planning, scheduling, availability and every commercial product downstream.

§ The scheduling and availability engine

The platform continuously answers the hardest operational question in vertical flight — *"which aircraft can be where, when, with whom on board?"* — automatically:

- **scheduler_rebuild** recomputes every aircraft's schedule (missions, ferry legs, returns, maintenance windows) for a time window. It runs nightly via `pg_cron` and is re-triggered immediately when bookings, network edges or maintenance events change.
- **Availability computation** enforces operational rules in real time: operational-event blackouts (per aircraft, per airfield, per crew member), booking cutoffs, join-flight cutoffs for shared flights, and seat-capacity checks — before any commercial logic runs.
- **A dedicated cache layer** (`cache` schema: month calendars, per-date slots) keeps availability queries fast at consumer-traffic volumes, with automatic invalidation when operational or pricing data changes.

This engine is operator-neutral. It schedules *missions* — a tour for a commercial brand, a medevac, a ferry flight and a private charter are the same kind of object to the core. That neutrality is what makes the platform a **turn-key solution for aviation activities** in general, rather than a tour-sales system.

§ Mission types: the full span of aviation activities

`mission_types` is an open taxonomy. The platform ships with:

TYPE	ACTIVITY
<code>tour</code>	Scheduled sightseeing products (the SilkSkyAir showcase — see case study)
<code>charter</code>	Private on-demand flights
<code>transfer</code>	Point-to-point passenger transport between network nodes
<code>medevac</code>	Medical evacuation operations
<code>ferry</code>	Repositioning flights, automatically planned by the scheduler

New activity types (cargo, survey, training, agricultural work) are additive rows, not new modules — the scheduling, crew, maintenance and disruption machinery applies unchanged.

§ Operational integrity by design

- **Event-sourced records** — operational state changes append events rather than overwrite rows, producing a complete audit trail (see Platform Asset Value for the compliance argument).
- **Role-segregated access** — network and scheduling functions are guarded by database-enforced privileges (`rls_has_privilege('module:scheduling:manage')` and related policies), so commercial users can never touch operational data.
- **Disruption handling as data** — an `operational_event` with a scope (aircraft, airfield or crew member) instantly and consistently blocks availability across every commercial channel, with no coordination required between teams.

§ Why this layer is the company's primary asset

1. **It encodes the physical network.** The helipads, heliports, routes and aircraft — the assets new management intends to own, expand and operate — have a one-to-one digital representation that is already running in production.
2. **It is activity-agnostic.** Tours are one of five mission types. The same core can operate transfers, medevac and charter businesses the day they are commercially relevant.
3. **It compounds.** Every node added to the graph increases the value of every other node (more routes, more products, more utilization options) — the classic network effect, captured in a schema built for it.
4. **It is separable.** The commercial features documented in the next chapter sit *on top of* this layer and can be white-labelled to any number of operators — see White-Label Separation.